

PMBOK / PMI | PMB-06

Project Management Plan

The integrated plan describing how the project will be executed, monitored and closed

Meridian Group

Programme Helios — Infrastructure and Platform Stack for AI GPU Compute at Scale

Field	Detail
Document title	Project Management Plan
Document reference	PMB-06-HEL-T2-v1.0
Project / Programme	Helios Tranche 2 — Scale Build
Version	1.0
Status	Baselined
Date	18 Sep 2026
Author	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager
Owner	Project manager
Approver	Sponsor and, where applicable, the governance board
Classification	Internal
Retention	7 years from programme closure

Document control

Version history

Version	Date	Author	Summary of change
0.1	04 Jun 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Initial draft
0.2	21 Jul 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Updated following workstream lead review
1.0	18 Sep 2026	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager	Baselined at the Tranche 2 funding gate

Reviewers

Name	Role	Review scope	Date reviewed
T. Nakamura, Chief Platform Architect	Chief Platform Architect	Technical content and solution alignment	08 Sep 2026
L. Haddad, CISO	CISO	Security, assurance and residency content	10 Sep 2026
C. Whitfield, Finance Business Partner	Finance Business Partner	Cost, funding and benefit figures	11 Sep 2026
M. Verity, Head of P3O	Head of P3O	Governance standards and completeness	15 Sep 2026

Approval

This product is baselined once approval is recorded below. Any subsequent change must go through change control.

Name	Role	Decision	Date
R. Al Mazrouei, Group CTO	Senior Responsible Owner / Group CTO	Approved	18 Sep 2026
H. Farrell, Director of Infrastructure	Director of Infrastructure	Approved	18 Sep 2026
L. Haddad, CISO	CISO	Approved subject to closure of ISS-003	18 Sep 2026

Related products

Reference	Product	Relationship
PMB-01	Project Charter	Authorises this plan
PMB-07	Scope Management Plan	Subsidiary plan
PMB-25	Change Management Plan	Governs changes to this plan
P2-10	Project Initiation Documentation	PRINCE2 equivalent

How to use this template

Aspect	Guidance
Purpose	Integrates and consolidates the subsidiary management plans and baselines into a single document defining how the project is executed, monitored, controlled and closed.
Framework	PMBOK / PMI — Integration Management — Develop Project Management Plan
Created when	During planning, after the charter is approved
Reviewed / updated	Updated only through approved change requests once baselined
Owner	Project manager
Approver	Sponsor and, where applicable, the governance board
Format options	Document, presentation, register entry, or tool record — the content matters, not the medium.
Tailoring	Reference the subsidiary plans rather than reproducing them. On a small project the subsidiary plans may be sections of this document rather than separate documents — record which approach you have taken.

This is a worked example. Every field has been completed with illustrative content for Programme Helios, a fictional AI GPU infrastructure and platform programme. All example content is shown in grey italic — the black text is the template itself. Replace the grey italic content with your own.

Quality criteria

Use these to check the product is fit for purpose before submitting it for approval.

- It references rather than duplicates the subsidiary plans
- The three baselines — scope, schedule, cost — are identified and their change control stated
- The development approach (predictive, iterative, hybrid) is stated and justified
- It describes how work will be executed, not just what will be produced
- It is baselined and thereafter changed only through change control

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1. Project overview

Summarise the charter in half a page. Reference it rather than repeating it.

Meridian Group operates fragmented AI compute across four departmental estates with an average GPU utilisation of 31% and annual public cloud GPU rental of AED 19.4m. Demand from AI Research, Fraud Analytics and the Retail division is growing faster than any single department can fund. Programme Helios consolidates that demand onto a single shared platform in DXB-1, scaling from a 256-GPU pilot to 4,096 GPUs across three tranches, with liquid cooling, a 400G RoCEv2 fabric, a multi-tenant orchestration platform and an MLOps stack.

2. Development approach

Field	Detail
Approach	Predictive / Iterative / Incremental / Agile / Hybrid
Rationale	Physical infrastructure has long lead times and low requirement volatility; the platform layer has short feedback loops and genuinely emergent requirements
Delivery cadence	Quarterly planning intervals with two-week iterations, against tranche-level gates
Phase structure	Three tranches, each ending in an end-of-tranche review and funding gate
Tailoring applied	Product Status Account and Configuration Item Record replaced by the CMDB export; Checkpoint Report replaced by the ART sync record

3. Project life cycle and phases

Phase	Purpose	Key deliverables	Gate / exit criteria	Approver
Tranche 1	Foundation — 256-GPU pilot cluster in DXB-1, proving power, cooling and fabric design	400G fabric commissioned and NCCL-validated	All-reduce efficiency at or above 92% on three consecutive 256-GPU runs	D. Okonkwo, Release Train Engineer
Tranche 2	Scale — 2,048 GPUs across DXB-1 halls A and B, production platform and MLOps stack	Parallel filesystem accepted at 1.2 TB/s sustained	All-reduce efficiency at or above 92% on three consecutive 256-GPU runs	L. Haddad, CISO
Tranche 3	Multi-tenancy and resilience — 4,096 GPUs, AUH-2 second site, chargeback and DR	400G fabric commissioned and NCCL-validated	Coolant leak alerts the NOC within 60 seconds and isolates the affected rack	E. Santos, Procurement Lead

4. Subsidiary management plans

Plan	Separate document?	Reference	Owner
Scope management plan	Defined by the Tranche 2 scope statement; changed only by approved change request	In scope: the physical infrastructure in DXB-1 halls A and B, the compute and storage estate, the network fabric, the orchestration and scheduling platform, the MLOps and developer experience layer, the security controls required for multi-tenancy, and the operational readiness required to run the estate. Out of scope: the models themselves, business-unit data engineering, the AUH-2 second site (Tranche 3), and any change to the existing corporate WAN.	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager
Requirements management plan	Partially	Solution intent wiki, DXB-1 platform space	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager
Schedule management plan	Tranche 2 completes 30 Jul 2027; tolerance of +4 weeks at programme level	Tranche 2 completes 30 Jul 2027; tolerance of +4 weeks at programme level	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager
Cost management plan	AED 118,000,000 for Tranche 2; tolerance of +5% before escalation	AED 118,000,000 for Tranche 2; tolerance of +5% before escalation	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager
Quality management plan	No open critical or high security findings; acceptance benchmarks met in full	No open critical or high security findings; acceptance benchmarks met in full	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager
Resource management plan	Approved establishment of 34 FTE; contractor cover requires Programme Board approval	Approved establishment of 34 FTE; contractor cover requires Programme Board approval	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager
Communications management plan	No	Solution intent wiki, DXB-1 platform space	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager
Risk management plan	No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO	No individual risk may remain above a residual score of 12 without SRO acceptance	D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager

Plan	Separate document?	Reference	Owner
	<i>acceptance</i>		
Procurement management plan	Yes	<i>Assurance evidence pack, Tranche 2 gate</i>	<i>D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager</i>
Stakeholder engagement plan	<i>Partially</i>	<i>Solution intent wiki, DXB-1 platform space</i>	<i>D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager</i>
Change management plan	No	<i>ALM tool — Helios ART board</i>	<i>D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager</i>
Configuration management plan	Yes	<i>ALM tool — Helios ART board</i>	<i>D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager</i>

5. Baselines

Baseline	Contents	Baselined on	Version	Change authority
Scope	Scope statement, WBS, WBS dictionary	<i>Defined by the Tranche 2 scope statement; changed only by approved change request</i>	v1.0	<i>D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager</i>
Schedule	Approved schedule model	<i>Tranche 2 completes 30 Jul 2027; tolerance of +4 weeks at programme level</i>	v1.0	<i>D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager</i>
Cost	Time-phased budget	<i>AED 118,000,000 for Tranche 2; tolerance of +5% before escalation</i>	v1.0	<i>D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager</i>
Performance measurement	Integrated scope, schedule and cost	<i>Baselined at the Tranche 2 funding gate on 18 Sep 2026, v1.0</i>	v1.0	<i>D. Okonkwo, Programme Manager</i>

6. Management reviews

Review	Frequency	Attendees	Inputs	Decisions
30 Nov 2026	Monthly	Service Operations and FM provider	Tranche 1 end-of-tranche review report and lessons register	Approved
15 Oct 2026	At each stage boundary	Business Owners and tenant representatives	Site capacity study and structural survey for hall B	Approved with conditions
18 Sep 2026	Each iteration	CISO and Security Architect	Approved chargeback rate card	Deferred to the next Board
25 Jun 2027	Weekly	Programme Manager and workstream leads	Vendor allocation letter and confirmed delivery schedule	Rejected

7. Configuration management approach

How project artefacts are versioned, stored and controlled.

Delivery is phased into three tranches, each ending with a formal review and a funding gate. Facilities and hardware workstreams follow a predictive approach with design freeze points, because their lead times and physical dependencies do not tolerate emerging requirements. The platform, MLOps and security workstreams run on a quarterly planning interval with an Agile Release Train, because their requirements are genuinely emergent and the feedback loop from researchers is short.

8. Performance measurement approach

How progress is measured — earned value, milestone completion, burn-down, or a combination.

Aspect	Method	Frequency	Threshold for escalation
Schedule performance	Packs accepted first time divided by packs submitted	Per gate	To the Programme Manager within one working day; to the SRO within three
Cost performance	Absolute value of (actual minus forecast) divided by forecast	Per gate	To the Programme Manager within one working day; to the SRO within three
Scope delivery	Items reviewed on time divided by open items	Monthly	In scope: the physical infrastructure in DXB-1 halls A and B, the compute and storage estate, the network fabric, the orchestration and scheduling platform, the MLOps and developer experience layer, the security controls required for multi-tenancy, and the operational readiness required to run the estate. Out of scope: the models themselves, business-unit data engineering, the AUH-2 second site (Tranche 3), and any change to the

Aspect	Method	Frequency	Threshold for escalation
			existing corporate WAN.
Quality	Complete benefit profiles divided by claimed benefits	Quarterly	To the Programme Manager within one working day; to the SRO within three

9. Project closure approach

How the project will be closed, what constitutes acceptance and how transition to operations will occur.

Delivery is phased into three tranches, each ending with a formal review and a funding gate. Facilities and hardware workstreams follow a predictive approach with design freeze points, because their lead times and physical dependencies do not tolerate emerging requirements. The platform, MLOps and security workstreams run on a quarterly planning interval with an Agile Release Train, because their requirements are genuinely emergent and the feedback loop from researchers is short.